

Volume 44 Prologue - "The Fateful Night"

Translated by: Archbishop of Transportation

——‘Twas a night that derailed the fates of many.

???: [——aAHGhgGHHAAAGHA!]

Despite his efforts to stifle it, he could not fully hold back the scream, a low roar of desperation echoing through the twilight as if to curse every last thing in this world.

His body contorting, froth spilling from the corners of his mouth, rivers of blood streaming from his eyes, his muscle fibers snapped apart, his bones cracked and shattered, and the heat scorching his blood vessels mercilessly ripped into his soul without a shred of compassion.

A sin, he had committed. An unforgivable sin. To that he would admit. To that, he repented from the very bottom of his heart.

*Then, at the very least, let my sin and this punishment be compensated with an equal reward.*

???: [AHGhghAAGHHHHAAAGHA!]

Empty. His hands were empty.

That which should have been grasped within his hands, had spilled through the gaps in his fingers, towards a place that could never be reached for the rest of eternity. Though it would have been better had it just vanished, the reality of it was even more helpless, and difficult to accept.

That now, it was here. Within the vessel of the most foolish life to ever walk this world, it now certainly resided, and yet.

???: [———]

As he suffered, cried out, grit his teeth, and continued to struggle through it all, a small “something” was watching his body. ——No, that was impossible. It was nothing more than paranoia induced by his own guilty conscience over his sin.

After all, he had already tucked him in. Promising that it would be the end of a long nightmare, and telling him that the next morning to come would surely be a dazzling one brimming with hope, he had caressed the red hair on his head until he was sound asleep.

Hence, there could not have been anyone watching him. ——He had failed to put an end to this nightmarish night. The promise that a hope-filled dawn would arrive the next day, he had failed to fulfill.

——Something like wanting to die sooner, was not a desire he could allow himself to have.

The nightmare had yet to conclude. His hopes had yet to be satisfied. His promise had yet to be fulfilled.

In order to deliver his beloved family into the future, giving up was the one thing he could not afford to do.

???: [——aAHGhgghhAAagha!]

Gritting his teeth to the point of fissuring, he endured the suffering. He endured the pain.

Receiving torment which had no end in sight, he had no other option but to endure, endure, endure, and make it through.

???: [———]

——The small “something” watching over him was nothing more than an illusion made manifest by his feelings of guilt.

Firmly treading upon the damp floor with his large, barefoot soles, he checked back over his shoulder countless times.

Nobody was pursuing him. There was no possibility of any pursuers being sent after him, either. After all, it was none other than one who passed such orders to those beneath him, who had been pulling all the strings behind the curtains of this night.

Nevertheless, nothing could make him call that a complete sense of security.

???: [Damnit, this sorta ridiculous affair...!]

As his voice quaked with irritation, he glared through the dim lighting with a bitter expression dashed upon the face of his giant body.

It was a dark space, underground. ——Since its very existence was only known to a few people, nobody was even patrolling it; it was the type of passageway that would get an outsider killed just for knowing about it.

For him to be passing through it, as a person who was undoubtedly an outsider, just who even was he anymore?

???: [——Shit.]

Grinding his teeth in a violent swell of emotion, he used all his strength to withstand his urge to slam his massive fists into the walls around him. That was not because he wished not to make any noise. It was because there was something unnecessary being carried within his arms.

The weight of that unnecessary something only served to enrage him more and more, irritating him, exacerbating——,

???: [——Aa.]

Suddenly, his eyes met with those of the *thing* in his arms, causing a “Ngh” to spill from his throat.

Those were the extremely repulsive, aggravating, crimson eyes that he despised more than anything in this world. ——Even amidst this darkness, they had managed to catch hold of his face, and it was apparent that their pupils were constricting.

If only he could raise his voice to a piercing note, and have this hidden passage completely destroyed alongside his own self, who had so obediently acquiesced to taking it.

Such a ruinous, intropunitive, self-destructive wish was——,

???: [——Uu.]

Tiny outstretched hands pattered upon his face, followed by the sight of a smile, causing that wish of his to fizzle out.

It made him think that all those self-destructive, intropunitive, and ruinous desires were completely worthless.

???: [Ta the bitter end, ya *humans* are utterly revoltin'.]

Regardless of whether they understood his feelings or not, those crimson eyes did not err in their judgment till the very end.

Even though he had had countless chances to cast them aside, to abandon them, to give up, and to put an end to all this, they had avoided them entirely, guiding these legs all the way to the end of this passageway.

Finally making it out of the passage, what awaited thereofth was a boundless night. ——This was the final chance he would ever receive to renounce the Covenant he had formed, and relinquish the future lying ahead with no end in sight.

???: [If you're gonna regret somethin', then ya oughta regret it in the grandest way possible.]

However, staking his aged beliefs and whatever little dignity he had left, he rejected that final chance.

???: [Don't be so conceited as ta think ya can tie me down with a Covenant. Have a look at me now. I'll eradicate humankind, and throw all their corpses together into the Great Waterfall.]

Harboring his long held hatred, ripened to the point of boiling, the giant figure proceeded forth. ——All the while, admonishing himself to not allow the deterrent power of those innocent eyes to become a reason for him to halt his legs in the slightest.

——And, those were the events of the night that went on to derail the fates of many.

